

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a business website:

Cinemas vs Movie Streaming Services

Technology is changing the way young people consume entertainment. Many youngsters are choosing to use online movie streaming services instead of going to the cinema to watch films.

The popularity of streaming services such as Netflix, Disney Plus, and Apple TV further increased during the COVID pandemic because cinemas were shut down everywhere. Now, more than 200 million people use Netflix to watch movies and TV shows. This is due to four main advantages it has over cinemas.

1. You can choose from thousands of movies and TV shows to watch.
2. The monthly price of Netflix is cheaper than one movie ticket.
3. There is original content on Netflix you cannot watch in cinemas.
4. You can watch movies anywhere on your phone and laptop.

A study also shows that after joining Netflix, 30% of people go to cinemas less often and 15% of them don't go to cinemas anymore.

While this is good news for movie streaming services, cinemas are closing down due to a lack of demand, and a number of the biggest cinema chains around the world have filed for bankruptcy.

This brings up the question: Is this the end of cinemas?



Your class is doing a project on the entertainment industry. Your group is discussing the increasing popularity of movie streaming services and how it impacts cinemas. You may want to talk about:

- whether going to cinemas is a popular pastime in Hong Kong
- what cinemas can do to compete with movie streaming services
- any disadvantages of movie streaming services
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like watching movies?
2. Do you go to the cinema often?
3. Which do you prefer: watching a movie in the cinema or at home?
4. Would you pay for a movie streaming service?
5. What can people learn from watching movies?
6. What is your most memorable experience of going to the cinema?
7. Do you think movie streaming services make people less social?
8. Do you think movie streaming services will eventually replace cinemas?